

Crescent Community Care Services Limited

STAFF CODE OF CONDUCT

Purpose OF THIS DOCUMENT

The purpose of this code is to provide a clear framework within which employees of the Crescent Community Care Services Limited are expected to conduct themselves. The Crescent community Care Services Limited strives to maintain a work environment for its staff and a learning environment for its students in which honesty, integrity and respect for fellow employees and the Service Users of Crescent community Care Services Limited constantly reflected in personal behaviour and standards of conduct.

Principles

Crescent Community Care Services Limited is a Domiciliary Care organisation and the actions and behaviour of its employees has an impact on the Service Users, as well as on the local environment and the community as a whole. Employees are expected to have regard for the impact of their personal behaviour on the Crescent Community Care Services Limited, colleagues, Service Users, the environment and our community.

Crescent Community Care Services Limited works with many stakeholders and other professionals in the Community. It is essential that all these stakeholders can have confidence that Crescent Community Care Services Limited maintains the highest standards of conduct in all matters of care and how they deal with Service Users, their families and other professionals and seeks to maintain high standards of ethical behaviour. Stringent procedural and audit arrangements are in place and employees are expected to ensure that decision making is open and fair and in conformity with the Company Policy or by the Directors of the Company.

This code covers some of the most important issues relating to personal conduct, and gives a framework of standards and behaviour guidelines, but it is not intended to be exhaustive. A full copy of the Policies and Procedures are given to all members of staff and at times when updated, copies will be sent to all staff.

Standards of personal behaviour

Equality of opportunity

One of Crescent Community Care Services Limited's core values is the promotion of inclusivity and valuing diversity'. Crescent Community Care Services Limited seeks to ensure that the work environment for its employees is supportive, and one where individual respect is shown to all. All members of staff, regardless of their gender, race, ethnic background, culture, (dis)ability, sexual orientation, age, religion, socio-economic status or any other factor will be supported and encouraged to perform to their potential. See Policy on Equal Opportunities.

Harassment and bullying

To secure an environment in which students and members of staff are able to flourish and to achieve their full potential, Crescent Community Care Services Limited is committed to ensuring that everyone is able to work without fear of harassment, bullying or intimidation. Everyone at Crescent Community Care Services Limited has a part to play by ensuring that their own behaviour, whether intentional or unintentional, does not constitute harassment. Crescent Community Care Services Limited will take action against inappropriate behaviour which shows lack of respect for others or which leads people to feel threatened. See the discrimination Policy and accompanying procedures.

Health and safety

Crescent Community Care Services Limited places a high priority on providing a safe working environment and will act positively to minimise the incidence of all workplace risks as required by the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974 and other associated legislation.

All activities should be carried out with the highest regard for the health and safety of employees, Service Users, their family and any other visitors and professionals. Our aim is excellence in health and safety, by means of continuous improvement of standards, and the comprehensive use of risk assessments so as to systematically remove the causes of accidents/incidents and ill-health. This, together with more specific aims and objectives, reflects the Crescent Community Care Services Limited's commitment to promote employee well being. See Policy on Health & Safety and Risk Assessment for further information.

Relationships with other members of staff, students and other clients and customers of the Crescent Community Care Services Limited

Crescent Community Care Services Limited does not concern itself with the private lives of its staff unless they affect its effective operation or its reputation.

Members of staff who are relatives or who have a close personal relationship should not normally have a supervisory, assessing or authorising relationship with each other.

Employees must inform their line manager if they have a close personal relationship with another employee, or a client or customer of Crescent Community Care Services Limited which could be considered by colleagues or others, as impacting on the way they conduct themselves at work. For more information, see the Policy on Working Relationships

Performance

Crescent Community Care Services Limited expects individuals to follow all reasonable rules and instructions given by those supervising or managing their activities and/or work areas. Health & Safety must be followed at all times and reporting to the office / supervisor where necessary.

Misuse of drugs and alcohol

It is a disciplinary offence to be on Crescent Community Care Services Limited premises and/or carrying out official duties of Crescent Community Care Services Limited when under the influence of alcohol or non-medically prescribed drugs. See the Alcohol and Drugs Policy

Conduct outside work

Crescent Community Care Services Limited does not seek to dictate how employees conduct themselves in their personal lives outside work. However, unlawful, anti-social or other conduct by employees which may jeopardise Crescent Community Care Services Limited's reputation or position will be dealt with through the disciplinary procedure.

Dress code

Crescent Community Care Services Limited operates a formal dress code for its employees. Employees must ensure that their dress is appropriate for the situation in which they are working and that they present a professional image and one that reflects sensitivity to customer perceptions. This may reflect their ethnicity and lifestyle, but should not be provocative or cause offence to those with whom they have contact.

Intellectual property

Where appropriate the rights to personal benefit from inventions, discoveries and patents are defined in the Intellectual Properties Policy. Crescent Community Care Services Limited has put in place facilities and procedures to maximise the potential benefits from such intellectual property.

Access to confidential information

Although Crescent Community Care Services Limited strives to conduct its business in an open fashion there will be times when individuals, through their positions as members of staff, become aware of confidential information, either about other individuals or in connection with Crescent

Community Care Services Limited's Service Users and staff. Individuals should be aware of the need to keep such matters confidential and to respect the proper channels of communication for such information.

Use of equipment for non-work purposes

The Crescent Community Care Services Limited will allow employees reasonable use of Crescent Community Care Services Limited equipment and facilities, provided that authorisation has been obtained from the appropriate Director, that the use does not interfere or conflict with the work of the Crescent Community Care Services Limited, and that any costs are met by the individual.

Private telephone calls

Employees may NOT use Crescent Community Care Services Limited or Service Users telephone facilities to make private calls. While working with the Service User's of Crescent Community care Services Limited, staff should not use their mobile telephones and ensure that the care is taking priority. If it is an emergency situation and the office are trying to make contact, then the member of staff may take the call and explain that they are busy with the Service User and that they will contact back as soon as physically possible. It is then the employee's responsibility to return the call.

Social Media Policy

There are a lot of Social Media Networks where it is easy for information about personal or professional information to be passed around and commented on. Employees should make themselves aware of the Policy on Social Networking and the problems caused by it. Although this paragraph is not exhaustive it is very easy for an employee to bring the Company into Disrepute and this will be dealt with under the Disciplinary Procedure.

Data protection

Crescent Community Care Services Limited holds and processes information about employees, Service Users, and other data subjects. When handling such information, Crescent Community Care Services Limited, and all staff or others who process or use any personal information, must comply with the Data Protection Principles which are set out in the Data Protection Act 1998. Any doubts or queries about data protection issues should be referred for guidance to the Information Compliance Officer. See Policy on Data Protection

Procedures

Raising matters of concern

Employees have a right and a duty to raise concerns which they may have about breaches of the law or propriety by Crescent Community Care Services Limited. This should normally be through their Management Team but in circumstances where this is not appropriate they may approach the Directors in confidence. No individual who expresses their views in good faith and in line with this guidance will be penalised for doing so. See the Policy on Whistleblowing

Breaches of this code

This code of conduct has been drawn up to provide a source of guidance to Crescent Community Care Services Limited's employees. It is not a contractual document and can be amended at any time by Crescent Community Care Services Limited. All staff must comply with both the provisions of this code and the Crescent Community Care Services Limited's policies and procedures, breaches of which will be taken seriously and may result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.

Reviewed by Marcus Kerridge-McColl

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